21074 CORPORATE VENTURING AND INNOVATION STRATEGY

Classe impartita in lingua inglese

Programs: INTENT (6 crediti - I sem. - OB | 6 cfu - ECON-07/A)
Class: 27 (I sem.)
Department: Management and Technology

Course director: GIANMARIO VERONA

Classe 27

GIULIA CORBELLA
Department of Management and Technology
Università Bocconi, Milan, Italy
giulia.corbella@unibocconi.it

LUCA MIGNINI
Department of Management and Technology
Università Bocconi, Milan, Italy
luca.mignini@unibocconi.it

GIANMARIO VERONA
Department of Management and Technology
Università Bocconi, Milan, Italy
gianmario.verona@unibocconi.it

Attenzione! Il programma di seguito riportato è da considerarsi valido SOLO per l'anno accademico 2026/2027.

MISSION

The course develops student’s understanding of how firms use technology and innovation to position themselves strategically, from the perspective of a Director of R&D, Corporate Development, and Corporate Venturing. It pays specific attention to the AI transformation which is impacting all industries in the recent years. For this purpose, it relies heavily on cases and examples, dealing with firms which have faced the challenges of managing innovation, technology strategy, and the digital transformation. Students are asked to actively participate in class discussions to confront the implications of technology and innovation on a firm’s strategy and to understand actions and reactions by Executives of Business Development when technology and innovation originate within the firm as well as when they change exogenously the environment where the firm operates.

COURSE CONTENT DETAILED - SCHEDULE

- INTENT cl. 27

Session	Date	Topic	Material	Instructor
1	8 Sept 2:45-4:15 pm	Industrial Revolutions and the emerging AI revolution	Schumpeter J., *The Theory of Economic Development* https://cruel.org/books/hy/shortschumpeter/SchumpeterTheoryofEconDev.pdf Dosi G., *Research Policy* http://sjbae.pbworks.com/w/file/fetch/38055602/dosi_1982.pdf	VERONA & MIGNINI
2	10 Sept 4:30-6:00 pm	From Theory to Practice: Why Innovation and Corporate Entrepreneurship are Crucial	McKinsey Report https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/tech-and-ai/our-insights/tech-forward/state-of-ai-trust-in-2026-shifting-to-the-agentic-era Mokyr J., Vickers C., and Ziebarth N.L., *Journal of Economic Perspectives* https://pubs.aeaweb.org/doi/pdfplus/10.1257/jep.29.3.31 Draghi M., *The*	VERONA

			future of European competitiveness https://commission.europa.eu/document/download/97e481fd-2dc3-412d-be4c-f152a8232961_en?filename=The%20future%20of%20European%20competitiveness%20_%20A%20competitiveness%20strategy%20for%20Europe.pdf	
3	15 Sept 2:45-4:15 pm	Corporate R&D	Strategy in the twenty-first century pharmaceutical industry: Merck & Co. and Pfizer Inc. [HBS 9707509] Arora A. et al., *Strategic Management Journal* https://sms.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/full/10.1002/smj.2693 Shane S.A., Chapter 4	VERONA
4	17 Sept 4:30-6:00 pm	Emergence of Dominant Designs	Responding to the Wii? [HBS 9709448]	VERONA

			Abernathy W.J. and Utterback J.M., *MIT Review* https://teaching.up.edu/bus580/bps/Abernathy%20and%20Utterback%2C%201978.pdf Shane S.A., Chapter 2	
5	22 Sept 2:45-4:15 pm	The role of demand: Adoption dynamics and Lead Users	Von Hippel E., *Democratizing Innovation* https://web.mit.edu/evhippel/www/books/DI/DemocIn.pdf Shane S.A., Chapter 3	VERONA
6	24 Sept 4:30-6:00 pm	Inertia of competences, organizations, and industrial systems	Kodak and the digital revolution (A) [HBS 9705448] Christensen C.M., *The Innovator's Dilemma* https://rudyct.com/InovBis/The%20Innovator's%20Dilemma%20(Clayton%20M.%20Christensen)2000.pdf	VERONA
7	29 Sept 2:45-4:15 pm	Group work kick-off		MIGNINI
8	1 Oct	Guest Speaker*		VERONA

	8:30-10:00 am			
9	6 Oct 2:45-4:15 pm	Ambidexterity and Corporate venturing and development	SNAM Case [SDA Bocconi] Tushman M. et al., *Industrial and Corporate Change* https://academic.oup.com/icc/article-abstract/19/5/1331/783939	VERONA
10	8 Oct 4:30-6:00 pm	Group work check		MIGNINI
11	13 Oct 2:45-4:15 pm	Building the agile organization	Leadership Online (A): Barnes & Noble vs. Amazon.com [HBS 9798063] Teece D.J. et al., *Strategic Management Journal* https://sms.onlinelibrary.wiley.com/doi/abs/10.1002/%28SICI%291097-0266%28199708%2918%3A7%3C509%3A%3AAID-SMJ882%3E3.0.CO%3B2-Z O'Reilly C.A. and Tushman M., *Research in Organizational Behavior* https://papers.ssrn.com/sol3/papers.cfm?abstract_id=978493	VERONA

12	15 Oct 8:30-10:00 am	Guest Speaker*		VERONA
		Mid-term break		
13	29 Oct 4:30-6:00 pm	Sustaining Innovation	Red Bull (A) [HBS 9714401] Shane S.A., Chapter 10	MIGNINI
14	3 Nov 2:45-4:15 pm	Delivering Innovation	Tesla, Inc. [MH 0067] Shane S.A., Chapter 7	MIGNINI
15	5 Nov 4:30-6:00 pm	Group work check		MIGNINI
16	10 Nov 2:45-4:15 pm	Make or Buy?	The Walt Disney Company and Pixar Inc: To acquire or not to acquire? [HBS 9709462] Shane S.A., Chapters 3 and 4	MIGNINI
17	12 Nov 4:30-6:00 pm	Open Innovation	Lego (A): The crisis [HBS 9713478] Chesbrough H.W., *Open Innovation* https://books.google.com/books/about/Open_Innovation.html?id=4hTRWStFhVgC	MIGNINI

			Shane S.A., Chapter 14	
18	17 Nov 2:45-4:15 pm	Market creation	$19B 4 txt app WhatsApp… omg! [HBS 9715441] Shane S.A., Chapter 10	MIGNINI
19	17 Nov 4:30-6:00 pm	Group work check		MIGNINI
20	24 Nov 2:45-4:15 pm	Creativity and Watches	Raffaelli R., *Administrative Science Quarterly* https://www.jstor.org/stable/48589581	MIGNINI
21	26 Nov 8:30-10:00 am	Guest Speaker*		MIGNINI
22	1 Dec 1:00-2:30 pm	Group work presentations		VERONA & MIGNINI
23	1 Dec 2:45-4:15 pm	Group work presentations		VERONA & MIGNINI
24	3 Dec 4:30-6:00 pm	Wrap up and takeaways		VERONA & MIGNINI
	11 Dec **25 Jan**	**Final Exam**		

* Subject to change based on Guest Speaker's availability.

TEACHING METHODS

Selection:

- Lectures
    - Lectures
- Guest speaker's talks (in class or in distance)
    - Case Study Analysis
- Collaborative Works / Assignments
    - Project work
    - Project Presentation
- Competitions/Hackathons

The course is highly interactive, and regular attendance is strongly recommended. Class interaction and participation will be assessed. Students will also complete a graded group project. A final written exam will assess students' overall understanding of the course content.

The final grade will be calculated as follows:

- Class participation: 30%
- Group work: 20%
- Final written exam: 50%

ASSESSMENT METHODS

Selected methods:	Continuous assessment	Partial exams	General exam
Written individual exam (traditional/online)			**x**
Open and/or closed answers questions exam			x
Collaborative Works / Assignment (report, exercise, presentation, project work etc.)	**x**		
Evaluation of oral presentation in class (possible)	x		
Active class participation (virtual,	**x**		

attendance)

ATTENDING STUDENTS

The final grade will be computed as follows:

- Class participation (30%) will be assessed at the group level. Students are expected to form their own groups of up to six members. Each group should choose a name and appoint a spokesperson, to whom the instructors will address any group-specific communications. The group's name and list of members, including the spokesperson, should be submitted by noon on Friday, September 11, via email to giulia.corbella@unibocconi.it. The assessment of class participation will be based on both groups' voluntary contributions and their responses to cold calls during case discussions.

- The group work (20%) will test students' ability to apply the concepts covered in class to a practical context. Working in self-selected groups, students will analyze how a real-world company has successfully leveraged Corporate Venturing and develop a clear understanding of the factors underlying its success.

- A final written exam (50%) will evaluate students' overall understanding of the course content.

To qualify as attending students, students must attend at least 75% of classes (attendance will be recorded at each session) and participate in the group project.

Attending-student status will remain valid for the December 2026 and January 2027 examination sessions.

NOT-ATTENDING STUDENTS

The assessment of non-attending students is based entirely on a final exam. The exam evaluates students' understanding of innovation, technological change and their management, as well as their ability to think critically and apply the models covered in the course to business situations involving technology and innovation.

GENAI USE

The use of Generative Artificial Intelligence tools by students, solely as support during teaching activities*, is:

- Consentito solo nei casi esplicitamente dichiarati nelle Modalita' didattiche e/o Metodi di valutazione
- Allowed only in cases explicitly stated in the "Teaching Methods" and/or "Assessment Methods" sections

TEACHING MATERIALS

- INTENT cl. 27

ATTENDING STUDENTS

- Handouts distributed throughout the course
- Cases:
    - Strategy in the twenty-first century pharmaceutical industry: Merck & Co. and Pfizer Inc. [HBS 9707509]
    - Responding to the Wii? [HBS 9709448]
    - Kodak and the digital revolution (A) [HBS 9705448]
    - SNAM Case [SDA Bocconi]
    - Leadership Online (A): Barnes & Noble vs. Amazon.com [HBS 9798063]
    - Red Bull (A) [HBS 9714401]
    - Tesla, Inc. [MH0067]
    - The Walt Disney Company and Pixar Inc: To acquire or not to acquire? [HBS 9709462]
    - Lego (A): The crisis [HBS 9713478]
    - $19B 4 txt app WhatsApp… omg! [HBS 9715441]
- Reading:
    - O'Reilly C.A. and Tushman M., 2008. Ambidexterity as a dynamic capability: Resolving the innovator's dilemma. *Research in Organizational Behavior.*
- Suggested reading: Shane S.A., 2009. Technology Strategy for Managers and Entrepreneurs. *Prentice Hall.*

All the material listed above, except for Shane (2009), constitutes exam material.

NON-ATTENDING STUDENTS

- Shane S.A., 2009. Technology Strategy for Managers and Entrepreneurs. *Prentice Hall. This is in substitution of the handouts for attending students.*
- Cases:
    - Strategy in the twenty-first century pharmaceutical industry: Merck & Co. and Pfizer Inc. [HBS 9707509]
    - Responding to the Wii? [HBS 9709448]
    - Kodak and the digital revolution (A) [HBS 9705448]
    - SNAM Case [SDA Bocconi]
    - Leadership Online (A): Barnes & Noble vs. Amazon.com [HBS 9798063]
    - Red Bull (A) [HBS 9714401]
    - Tesla, Inc. [MH0067]
    - The Walt Disney Company and Pixar Inc: To acquire or not to acquire? [HBS 9709462]
    - Lego (A): The crisis [HBS 9713478]
    - $19B 4 txt app WhatsApp… omg! [HBS 9715441]
- Reading:
    - O'Reilly C.A. and Tushman M., 2008. Ambidexterity as a dynamic capability: Resolving the innovator's dilemma. *Research in Organizational Behavior.*

All the material listed above constitutes exam material.

Readings can be downloaded from the Bocconi Library website.

Instructions on how to download the cases will be provided in class. The cases will be available for a limited period of time. All students, both attending and non-attending, should download them before the end of the course.

HONOR CODE

Bocconi University conceives of education as an ongoing process that stretches across a person's entire professional life. The University hopes that the entire Bocconi community will respect the values of fairness and correctness associated with it, values which inspire and guide the conduct of all community members as they pursue common objectives and a shared mission. Bocconi University is also committed to building a truly inclusive climate based on diversity. With the collaboration of faculty and students, it aims to ensure a safe learning

environment free from any form of discrimination based on race, religion, gender, geography, age, disability or sexual orientation, in which there is room for a diversity of approaches and where discussions are always conducted in a respectful manner. The Bocconi University Honor Code is published on the website at http://www.unibocconi.eu/honorcode, we encourage all students to read it.

The pin code to record your presence with the Attendance procedure must be entered in the classroom in the presence of the faculty member who handles the recording. For 'Attendance', presence for the entire duration of the activity is intended. In case of an improper use of the Attendance recording procedure by students - e.g. entering the pin to record attendance while outside the classroom, unexcused exit from the classroom before the end of activities - a disciplinary sanction equal to a six-month suspension from exams/graduation will be given to the student.

Aggiornato al 04/09/2026 15:30